BOOK ONE

CHAPTER 1
THE CHAIN

Graduation night

SEALED

Open only when the table begins this chapter.

Book One · Chapter 1: The Chain (Graduation night)

Marcus can see the second number on everything now, and he teaches it as fast as he can: to Nia, who teaches the next one, who teaches the next.

Setup

Set up a Block Party (the 25-minute game: Lending, Housing and Education, 8 rounds, no roles), with the Terrell rule.

The twist

A Block Party with the Terrell rule. The Chain: when a learner says the second number back, they at once teach one more player in that district, for free.

Ending the chapter

If anyone was burned by the Terrell rule, the ledger reads Terrell. If you won, the block learns Civic Armor: from Chapter 2 on, every Teach comes with cover.

Balance-tested with computer players at 1–5 players (python3 balance_test.py, CAMPAIGNS and SOLO). Solo: 5 actions, Teach a neighbor, trace 2 threads (RULES.md, Solo).

THE TWIST Chapter 1

The Chain

A Block Party with the Terrell rule. The Chain: when a learner says the second number back, they at once teach one more player in that district, for free.

THE CHAIN every Teach

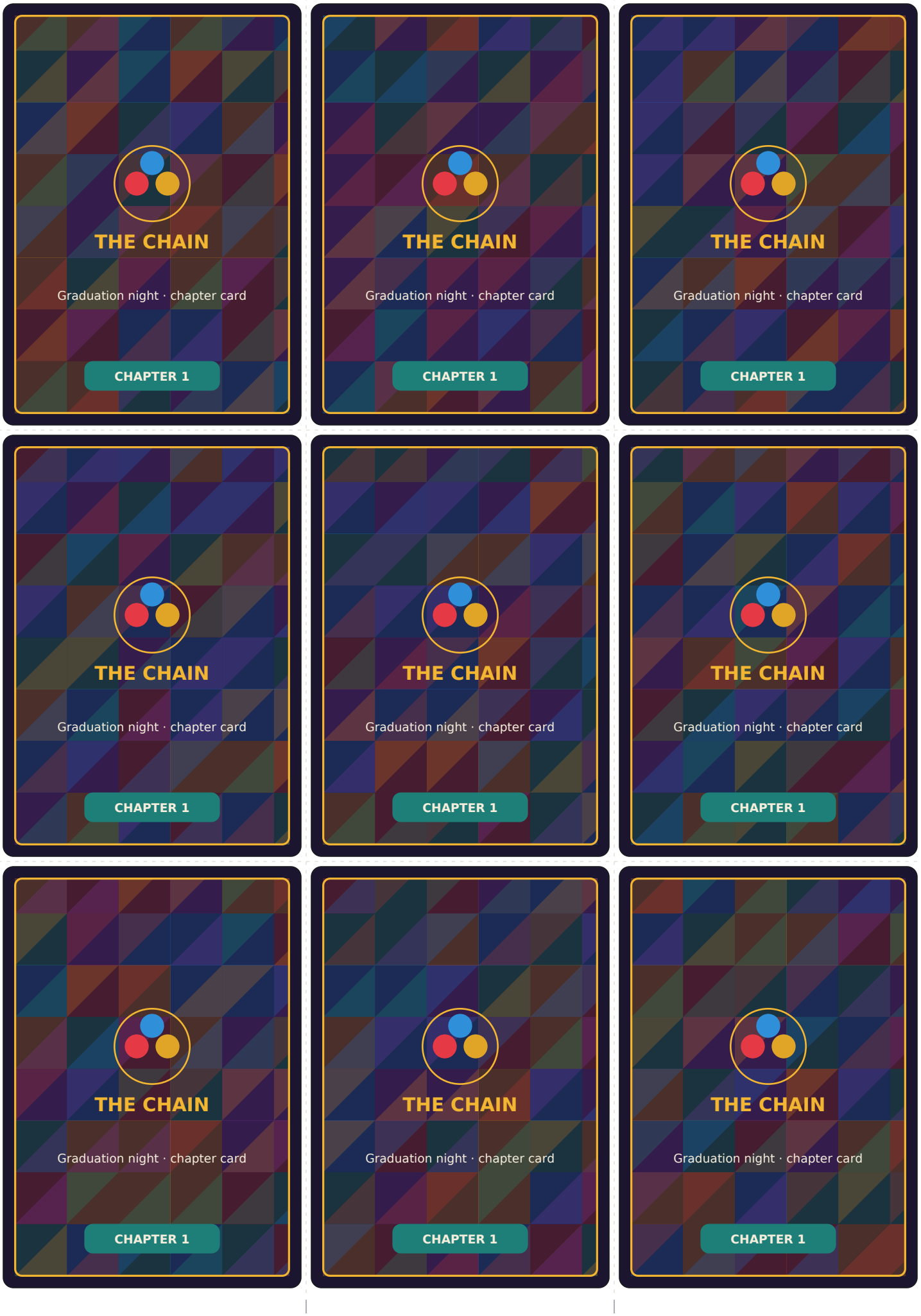
Pass It On

When a learner says the second number back, they at once teach one more player in that district (one who reads it less), for free.

BOOK ONE after the chapter

What It Writes Down

If anyone was burned by the Terrell rule, the ledger reads Terrell. If you won, the block learns Civic Armor: from Chapter 2 on, every Teach comes with cover.


THE CHAIN
Graduation night · chapter card
CHAPTER 1

Book One — the table's ledger

One sheet for the four chapters. Each one writes down what the next one reads.

1 · The Chain

Burned by the Terrell rule? ☐ → write TERRELL

Won? ☐ → the block learns CIVIC ARMOR (every Teach comes with cover)

2 · The Net

Who quit the Desk? _____

They start Chapter 3 with Read 1 everywhere

3 · The Crown

Who wore the Crown? _____

If anyone did: one extra strike in Chapter 4's first round

4 · The Empty Throne

Won? ☐

The book's last scene is on a porch. If you won, read it aloud.

In Chapter 3, if TERRELL is written down, every block player starts with 1 less Trust.